	MANAGEMENT OF CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION	
	Document no: ASMF4.3.	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Table of Contents

Purpose 2
Scope 2
Definition 2
Responsibilities 2
Procedure steps 3
Record to maintain 3
Training 4
Review and audits 4
Revision table 5

CONTROLLED DOC

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	01	02/2029

	MANAGEMENT OF CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION	
AzurESky	Document no: ASMF4.3.	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

1. Purpose

To ensure all confidential information obtained or generated during the production of Reference Materials (RMs) is protected and handled in accordance with ISO 17034:2016 Clause 4.3.

2. Scope

Applies to all personnel, subcontractors, and external parties involved in RM production, including handling of customer data, proprietary methods, and internal technical records.

3. Definitions

- **Confidential Information**: Any non-public data, documents, or communications received from clients or generated internally that must be protected from unauthorized disclosure.
- **Authorized Disclosure**: Release of confidential information permitted by law or contractual agreement.

4. Responsibilities

- **Top Management**: Ensures implementation and enforcement of confidentiality policies.
- **Laboratory Manager**: Maintains records and monitors compliance.
- **All Personnel**: Adhere to confidentiality agreements and report breaches

CONTROLLED DOC

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	01	02/2029

	MANAGEMENT OF CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION	
	Document no: ASMF4.3.	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

5. Procedure steps

5.1. Identification of confidential information

- Classify all incoming and internal data as confidential, restricted, or public. This includes customer specifications, propriety methods, RM characterisation data, and subcontractor reports.

5.2. Access control

- Limit access to confidential information to authorised personnel only.
- Maintain access logs and permissions within the document control system.

5.3. Confidentiality agreements

- All staff, subcontractors, and visitors must sign a confidentiality agreement.
- Agreements will be reviewed annually or upon a role change.
- All client or personnel information from secondary sources other than the client/personnel shall be treated as such, unless the source states otherwise and that such information received prior authentication from the client.

5.4. Handling and storage

- All physical documents to be locked in cabinets, digital files in encrypted systems.

5.5. Disclosure Protocol

In the event where disclosure is required law or by contract agreement:

- Notify all individuals concerned before disclosure, unless prohibited by law. **The clients/customers shall be notified in writing via email and records of correspondence shall be retained.**
- **Information relating to a customer that is obtained from sources other than the customer (e.g. regulators, accreditation bodies, or third parties) shall be treated as confidential. Such information shall be protected from unauthorized access or disclosure and shall be used only for its intended**

CONTROLLED DOC

	MANAGEMENT OF CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION	
	Document no: ASMF4.3.	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

purpose. Disclosure of this information shall only occur with the agreement of the source of the information in writing, unless disclosure is required by law or authorized by contractual or regulatory obligations.

- Record the nature, reason, and recipient of the disclosure.

6. Record Maintenance

- Signed confidentiality agreement ie. Non-disclosure agreement
- Access logs
- Breach investigation reports
- Training records
- Disclosure records

7. Training

- Conduct annual training on confidentiality policies and ISO 17034 and ISO 17043 requirements

Examples of confidentiality breaches:

Scenario	Description	Impact
Unattended Documents	A technician leaves printed RM characterization data on a shared desk overnight	Risk of unauthorized access or data leakage
Email Misfire	A staff member accidentally sends a customer's proprietary method to the wrong client	Breach of contract and potential legal liability
Unauthorised sharing	A subcontractor discusses RM composition with a third party not bound by NDA.	Violation of ISO 17034 and ISO 17043 as well as reputational damage
Public disclosure	Staff mention client-specific RM details during a conference presentation.	Breach of trust and confidentiality

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	01	02/2029

CONTROLLED DOC

	MANAGEMENT OF CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION	
	Document no: ASMF4.3.	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

8. Review and Audit

- Procedure reviewed annually during management review
- Internal audits to verify compliance and effectiveness

9. Revisions

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision
00	Not a change but rather an addition. How customers will be informed in the event that their confidential information is to be released as required by law or an audit.	To address a gap in the system as identified by SANAS during the document review.
00	An addition to address confidentiality of information about the customer from sources other than the customer shall be treated as such, unless agreed by the source.	Clause 4.2.3 was not addressed as identified by SANAS.

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	01	02/2029

CONTROLLED DOC